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# Riverside Braces for Record Autumn Storm This Weekend

By Staff Reporter | October 8, 2026 | Weather

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**RIVERSIDE** – Residents are being urged to prepare for what forecasters call the strongest autumn storm to hit the region in more than a decade, with heavy rain and gusty winds expected to arrive Saturday evening.

## What to Expect

The National Weather Service says as much as four inches of rain could fall between Saturday night and Sunday afternoon, with wind gusts reaching 55 miles per hour along the river corridor. Flash flooding is possible in low-lying neighborhoods, and falling branches may cause scattered power outages.

## City Response

Public Works crews have spent the week clearing storm drains and inspecting flood barriers along Riverfront Drive. "We are taking this storm seriously," said Public Works Director Maria Alvarez. "Our goal is to make sure every resident has the information and resources they need before the first drop falls."

Emergency shelters will open Saturday at 6 p.m. at Riverside High School and the Community Recreation Center. Pets are welcome at the recreation center.

## Road Closures

- Riverfront Drive between 2nd and 9th Streets – closing Saturday at 5 p.m.
- Mill Creek Bridge – may close if water levels rise above the warning mark.
- Lower Park Road – closed through Monday for tree removal.

## Safety Tips

1. Charge phones and portable batteries before the storm arrives.

2. Secure or bring indoors outdoor furniture, bins and decorations.
3. Keep at least three days of water, food and medication on hand.
4. Never drive through flooded roads – turn around, don't drown.
5. Report downed power lines to the utility company, and stay far away from them.

## Looking Ahead

The storm is expected to move out by Monday morning, with clearing skies and cooler temperatures following. Officials say damage assessments will begin as soon as conditions are safe, and residents can find updates on the city website and local radio.

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